

# Advanced Time And Sales (The Tape)

Platform Windows | intermediate | 12 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

Advanced Time And Sales is the DeepCharts tape: a live list where every executed trade appears as one row the moment it prints. Where a chart compresses activity into bars, the tape shows you each individual transaction — its time, its size, and which side of the market was the aggressor.

This article covers the window itself: how to open it, what the row colors mean, the three optional bottom panels (Bid/Ask, Delta, book imbalance), and every setting in the **Chart Settings** and **TS Settings** dialogs.

## What it is

The window answers one question: who is trading right now, how much, and at what price. Each row is a single trade print with three columns — **Time**, **Volume** and **Price**. The price cell is color-coded by where the trade executed, so at a glance you can see whether buyers are lifting the ask or sellers are hitting the bid. Optional panels at the bottom of the window aggregate those prints into running per-side totals, a delta bar, or a live view of the resting order book.

If you are new to aggressor-side logic (why a trade "at the ask" means an aggressive buyer), read Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta first — the tape makes much more sense with that model in mind.

## When to use it

- Confirming whether a fast move is backed by real aggressive volume or thin prints.
- Watching execution speed and print sizes around a level you care about — pairs well with Speed of Tape and Big Trades.
- Monitoring one side only (all buys or all sells) with the trade-side filter.
- Keeping a compact running delta or bid/ask volume tally without opening a full chart.
- Watching resting-book pressure with the book-imbalance panel while you manage an entry on the Advanced DOM Window.

## Quick start

1. In the main bar, open **New** → **Adv. Time And Sales**.
2. In the **Select Instrument** window, pick your instrument (for example NQ) and confirm. Only exchanges you subscribed in Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed appear here — an empty picker means nothing is subscribed yet.
3. The tape window opens and starts filling with live prints.

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] The New menu open in the DeepCharts main bar with Adv. Time And Sales highlighted, and the Select Instrument dialog visible with NQ selected `dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-01.png`

**Note:** A freshly opened tape starts empty and fills only as new trades print. On video-verified behavior, duplicated and new Time And Sales windows showed no historical backfill — in a quiet market the window can stay sparse for a while. This appears to be by design, though exact backfill behavior is **[CONFIRM: does a new/duplicated Adv. TS window intentionally load no trade history?]**.

## Window anatomy

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Full Adv. Time And Sales window on NQ showing the title bar icons (logo, gear, link, minimize, close), the full-width symbol dropdown, and a mixed tape of green and pink price cells with blue volume numbers `dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-02.png`

- **Title bar**, left to right: the DeepCharts logo, the **gear** icon (the settings hub — everything lives here), the square **link** icon, minimize and close. The link icon was not demonstrated in our source material; it is presumably the standard window-link color groups (see Link Windows with Color Groups), but exact behavior may vary.
- **Symbol dropdown** — full width, directly under the title bar (for example NQ-202609). Changing it switches the tape to another instrument.
- **The tape** — columns **Time | Volume | Price**. Rows appear top-down as trades execute. Volume prints in blue text.
- The window is freely resizable; columns stretch with it.

## How to read it

Each row's **Price** cell background encodes the aggressor side:

| Color | Meaning                                                                           |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Green | Trade executed at the ask — buy aggressor                                         |
| Pink  | Trade executed at the bid — sell aggressor                                        |
| Gray  | Unconfirmed — likely a trade executed between the bid and ask (inside the spread) |

The gray reading is an inference, not a confirmed fact: the **TS Settings** color fields include a **Between Bid/Ask background** that is gray by default, which strongly suggests gray rows are inside-spread prints — but this is pending confirmation, so treat it as likely rather than certain. The same color sets also include **Below Bid** and **Above Ask** backgrounds, meaning the tape can distinguish prints outside the quoted spread as well; when those colorings trigger is **[CONFIRM: exact conditions for Below Bid / Above Ask row coloring]**.

Try it on the live tape below — hover any print to pause the stream and see why it is green or pink, and switch the All/Ask/Bid filters to watch the tape turn one color.

[WIDGET: tape-lab]

A tape that is suddenly all one color usually is not the market — it is the trade-side filter (next section).

## The gear menu

The gear icon opens the full menu: **All Trades / Ask Trades / Bid Trades** (a three-way filter), **Enable Bid/Ask**, **Enable Delta**, **Chart Settings**, **Enable book imbalance**, **Book imbalance settings**, **Duplicate Adv. TS**, **Always on Top**, **Template (Load / Save As)**, **Rebuild TS**, **Rename TS** and **Settings TS**.

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Adv. Time And Sales gear menu fully open showing all items: the All/Ask/Bid Trades filter with checkmark on All Trades, the Enable Bid/Ask, Enable Delta, Chart Settings, Enable book imbalance, Book imbalance settings, Duplicate Adv. TS, Always on Top, Template, Rebuild TS, Rename TS and Settings TS entries  
dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-03.png

### Trade-side filters

**All Trades** (default) shows the mixed tape. **Ask Trades** shows only ask-side executions — every visible row turns green. **Bid Trades** shows only bid-side executions — all pink. The same choice also exists inside **Settings TS** as **TS Mode**: the two stay in step

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Tape with the Ask Trades filter active — every row green — and the gear menu open showing the checkmark moved to Ask Trades  
dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-04.png

### Bid/Ask panel

**Enable Bid/Ask** (off by default) adds a panel to the lower third of the window. It starts empty with a full-width green **Reset** button, then grows two boxes: purple on the left and green on the right, each with a count

underneath. The boxes grow as trades print, and **Reset** zeroes both counters.

Based on the tape's color convention, the purple box appears to track bid-side traded volume and the green box ask-side volume since the last reset — a reasonable reading, but the exact semantics are **[CONFIRM: Bid/Ask panel — do the two counters equal cumulative contracts traded at bid vs at ask since last Reset?]**

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Adv. Time And Sales with the Bid/Ask bottom panel enabled — purple box on the left, green box on the right, contract counts under each box and the full-width green Reset button

dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-05.png

### **Delta panel**

**Enable Delta** (off by default) shows a single horizontal bar in the bottom panel: purple while the running delta is negative, green when positive, with two stacked numbers that grow as trades print (for example -5 / -3 growing to -14 / -12 during selling). **Reset** zeroes the bar.

The **Chart Settings** text fields include separate colors for "Delta Volume" and "Delta Trade", so the two numbers are most likely delta volume (top) and delta trade count (bottom) — exact meaning unconfirmed

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Delta bottom panel showing a purple negative delta bar with two stacked negative numbers, then the same panel green after delta turned positive dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-06.png

### **Book imbalance panel**

**Enable book imbalance** (off by default) switches the bottom panel to a resting-book view: one number on the left (bid side) and one on the right (ask side). When both sides are equal, only plain numbers show. When one side dominates, that side grows a colored box sized by its share — a green box on the left when the bid book dominates, a red box on the right when the ask book dominates. The colors are confirmed by the **Imbalance settings** dialog (Bid Volume = green, Ask Volume = red).

Unlike the other two panels this mode has no **Reset** button — it mirrors the current book rather than accumulating. What exactly the numbers sum (best bid/ask level only, or several book levels) is unconfirmed. as is whether the panel needs 1 level 2 depth data to populate.

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Book imbalance bottom panel in two states — equal values shown as plain numbers, and a dominant bid side with a green box on the left sized proportionally dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-07.png

### **Window utilities**

- **Duplicate Adv. TS** — opens a second tape window with the same symbol preselected. The duplicate starts with an empty tape and fresh panel counters, and each window keeps its own settings.
- **Always on Top** — keeps the window above others; exact behavior was not demonstrated in our source material but the menu item matches the standard window option.
- **Template** → **Load / Save As** — save or load a named Time And Sales configuration, the same pattern as chart and DOM templates (Templates and Workspaces).
- **Rebuild TS** — clears and rebuilds the tape. Use it as a light first fix when the tape looks glitched or frozen. Panel counters reset to zero after a rebuild.
- **Rename TS** — renames the window. **[CONFIRM: Rename TS dialog contents — never opened in source material]**

## **Settings reference**

### **Chart Settings (Bid/Ask and Delta panels)**

**Gear** → **Chart Settings** controls how the two accumulating panels measure and display.

| Section        | Setting                                                  | What it does                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GENERAL        | <b>Period Mode</b>                                       | Accumulation window. Default <b>Resettable</b> — accumulate until you press Reset. Other options: <b>Fixed count</b> , <b>Fixed seconds</b> — these appear to auto-reset using <b>Period Length</b> as the window, but exact behavior is unconfirmed. |
| GENERAL        | <b>Period Length</b>                                     | Number used by the Fixed modes. Default 10.                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| GENERAL        | <b>Visual Mode</b>                                       | Default <b>Pos and neg</b> . <b>[CONFIRM: other Visual Mode options]</b>                                                                                                                                                                              |
| GENERAL        | <b>Enable Shortcut Reset</b>                             | Off by default. <b>[CONFIRM: which shortcut this binds]</b>                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| COLOR SETTINGS | <b>Bid Volume / Ask Volume / Bid Trades / Ask Trades</b> | Color swatches for the panel boxes and delta bar (bid = purple, ask = green by default).                                                                                                                                                              |
| COLOR SETTINGS | <b>Color only dominant delta</b>                         | Toggle affecting the delta bar coloring.                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| TEXT SETTINGS  | <b>Text Size / Text Color</b>                            | Panel text styling. Default size 14.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| TEXT SETTINGS  | <b>Pos./Neg. Delta Volume, Pos./Neg. Delta Trade</b>     | Separate color pickers for the two numbers printed on the delta bar, per sign.                                                                                                                                                                        |

**Apply** applies without closing: **OK** closes the dialog.

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] Chart Settings dialog open showing the GENERAL section with Period Mode dropdown expanded listing Resettable, Fixed count and Fixed seconds dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-08.png

### Book imbalance settings

**Gear** → **Book imbalance settings** opens the **Imbalance settings** dialog: COLOR SETTINGS (**Bid Volume** = green, **Ask Volume** = red) and TEXT SETTINGS (**Text Size** default 14, **Bid color**, **Ask color**).

### TS Settings (the tape itself)

**Gear** → **Settings TS** opens the **TS Settings** dialog with five collapsible sections:

| Section         | Settings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GENERAL         | <b>Back color</b> , <b>Border color</b> , <b>Font color</b> , <b>Font size</b> (default 12.00), <b>Bold font</b> (applies live on Apply), <b>Input data</b> (default <b>Volume</b> ; switching to <b>Order</b> changes the middle column header — the tape then shows an order-related count per print instead of contract volume; exact semantics and any further options unconfirmed), <b>Show milliseconds</b> (Time column becomes e.g. 02:03:42.382), <b>TS Mode</b> ( <b>All trades / Ask trades / Bid trades</b> — same as the gear filter). |
| FILTER SETTINGS | <b>Filter 1</b> (number, default 0), <b>Enable Filter 2</b> (off), <b>Filter 2</b> (number, default 0). These look like minimum-size thresholds that gate the FILTER 1 / FILTER 2 color sets for highlighting larger prints — unconfirmed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| FILTER 1        | Ten color fields: <b>Bid</b> , <b>Below Bid</b> , <b>Between Bid/Ask</b> (gray by default), <b>Ask</b> , <b>Above Ask</b> backgrounds plus the five matching text colors.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| FILTER 2        | The same ten fields with a second, more saturated color set.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

| Section     | Settings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ALERT SOUND | <b>Enable Filter 1, Bid Filter 1</b> and <b>Ask Filter 1</b> sound dropdowns with play-preview buttons, <b>Enable Filter 2, Bid/Ask Filter 2</b> . Presumably plays the chosen sound when a print passes the filter on that side — trigger semantics unconfirmed. |

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] TS Settings dialog open on the GENERAL section showing Back/Border/Font color swatches, Font size 12.00, Bold font toggle, Input data dropdown set to Volume, Show milliseconds toggle and TS Mode dropdown `dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-09.png`

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] TS Settings dialog scrolled to FILTER SETTINGS and the expanded FILTER 1 section showing the Bid, Below Bid, Between Bid/Ask (gray), Ask and Above Ask background and text color fields `dc-en-adv-time-and-sales-10.png`

## Troubleshooting

- **Tape is empty or blank.** New and duplicated windows start empty and fill only from live prints — wait for trades, confirm the feed is connected and the market is open, then try **Gear** → **Rebuild TS**. If the tape stays dead while charts tick, see Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving.
- **Only green rows / only pink rows.** The trade-side filter is set to Ask Trades or Bid Trades. Switch back to **All Trades** (also check **Settings TS** → **TS Mode**).
- **Middle column says Order instead of Volume.** **Settings TS** → **GENERAL** → **Input data** was switched — set it back to **Volume**.
- **Tape looks frozen or glitched.** **Gear** → **Rebuild TS** first; if the whole feed is down, work through Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed (Checklist).
- **Numbers in the bottom panel will not reset.** The book-imbalance mode has no Reset by design — it mirrors the current book. Only the Bid/Ask and Delta modes have the green Reset control.

## Tips and common mistakes

- The bottom panel shows one mode at a time — Bid/Ask, Delta, or book imbalance. If the panel does not look like you expect, check which of the three gear toggles is active.
- Use **Duplicate Adv. TS** plus the symbol dropdown to run two tapes side by side on different instruments; each window keeps independent filters, panels and settings.
- Save your configured tape as a template (**Gear** → **Template** → **Save As**) so you can rebuild your layout in seconds on a new workspace.
- Do not read the gray rows as a definitive signal — the inside-spread interpretation is likely but not confirmed. If your strategy depends on it, verify with support first (How to Get Help (Chat, Diagnostic Report, Support)).
- Milliseconds (**Show milliseconds**) are worth enabling when you study burst activity — same-second prints become distinguishable.

## Related articles

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Advanced DOM Window
- Speed of Tape
- Big Trades
- Deep Trades
- Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed